ACT 1 — ORIGIN (0:00–6:00)

SCENE 1 — CHILDHOOD

INT. SMALL BEDROOM – NIGHT

Dim light. Insect crawling on wooden floor.

Young ADRIAN (8) watches it.

His hand slowly presses down.

Crunch.

STEPFATHER (O.S.)
You think staring at walls makes you smart?!

Door slams open.

Adrian doesn’t cry. He just stares.

Cut to mirror.

Young Adrian touches his own reflection.

NARRATOR (V.O.)
When pain becomes routine, it stops feeling like pain.
It becomes practice.

Cut to black.

ACT 2 — PRESENT DAY (6:00–12:00)

SCENE 2 — CAMPUS INTRO

EXT. COLLEGE QUAD – DAY

Students everywhere.

Marco holding phone.

MARCO
If there’s really a killer on campus, we’ll expose him.

Group laughs.

Adrian stands slightly behind them.

KEN
Bro, what if it’s one of us?

Everyone laughs.

Adrian smiles.

ADRIAN
Then we’re terrible detectives.

Subtle. Calm.

Camera never centers him.

SCENE 3 — FIRST STALKING

EXT. WALKWAY – EVENING

Ella walking alone.

POV from behind tree.

Breathing slow.

Ella checks her phone.

Footsteps.

She turns.

ELLA
Hello?

Cut to struggle sounds.

Quick flashes:
Hand.
Fabric tearing.
Ground impact.

Silence.

ACT 3 — INVESTIGATION (12:00–20:00)

SCENE 4 — CRIME SCENE

Police tape.

Mystery group observing.

LUIS
He’s careful. No witnesses.

ADRIAN
That means he’s patient.

MARCO
Or he’s lucky.

Adrian crouches near bench.

An insect crawls near his shoe.

He crushes it slowly.

Ken notices.

KEN
You good?

ADRIAN
Yeah. Just hate bugs.

SCENE 5 — THEORY ROOM

INT. CLASSROOM – NIGHT

Photos on table.

JAX
Look at timing. Both victims alone.

PAOLO
Maybe it’s someone socially isolated.

Silence.

They glance around jokingly.

Adrian shrugs.

ADRIAN
Or someone social enough to not look isolated.

They ignore that line.

SECOND MURDER

SCENE 6 — PARKING AREA

Ryan walking fast.

Phone call.

RYAN
Yeah, I’m heading out now—

Shadow moves behind him.

Phone drops.

Struggle.

Ryan gasps.

Knife glints but never fully shown.

Silence.

ACT 4 — SUSPICION (20:00–25:00)

SCENE 7 — MARCO DOUBTS

Marco approaches Adrian alone.

MARCO
You were near both scenes.

ADRIAN
So were you.

MARCO
You’re too calm.

ADRIAN
What do you want me to do? Cry?

Beat.

MARCO
I’m just saying… something’s off.

Adrian leans closer.

ADRIAN
You’re looking for someone broken.
What if he’s not?

Marco unsettled.

FINAL ELIMINATION

SCENE 8 — ABANDONED BUILDING

Night.

Marco follows Adrian.

MARCO
Stop pretending.

Adrian stops walking.

Silence.

ADRIAN
Pretending what?

MARCO
I saw you near Ryan. You were watching.

Adrian turns slowly.

For the first time, camera almost centers him.

ADRIAN
You think you’re smart.

Marco steps closer.

MARCO
I know it’s you.

Beat.

Adrian smiles faintly.

ADRIAN
No.
You just want it to be me.

Sudden attack.

Marco struggles.

MARCO
You’re sick!

Adrian whispers during struggle:

ADRIAN
No.
I’m careful.

Marco collapses.

Silence.

Adrian adjusts his shirt calmly.

Walks away.

FINAL SCENE (25:00–30:00)

Morning.

Police assume killer fled.

Mystery group shattered.

Ken crying.

Luis frustrated.

Adrian sits beside them.

KEN
We were so close…

Adrian nods.

ADRIAN
Yeah.

NARRATOR (V.O.)
They searched for patterns.

For trauma.
For madness.

Camera slowly moves.

First time fully centered on Adrian.

NARRATOR (V.O.)
They never searched for ordinary.

Flashbacks:
Adrian behind Ella in cafeteria.
Adrian near Ryan's car earlier.
Adrian guiding theories.

Back to present.

Adrian looks directly into camera.

No smile. Just emptiness.

ADRIAN (softly)
You never looked.

Long silence.

Cut to black.

No music.

End.

PERFORMANCE NOTES FOR ADRIAN

- Never overact.
- Speak calmly.
- Blink less during tense moments.
- Minimal facial expression.
- Smile only slightly.

The scarier he is, the less dramatic he acts.